

NHS SATISFACTION ANALYSIS

British Social Attitudes Survey 2021 | R | Quantitative Research

Research question

Does NHS satisfaction differ across income, marital status, children, sex, education and age?

Sample and preparation

Complete-case analytical sample: $N = 3,307$. Mean NHS satisfaction = 2.60.

Non-substantive responses were excluded. Age bands were represented using midpoints.

Alpha level: 0.05. NHS satisfaction was treated as continuous for parametric analysis.

Descriptive findings

Income means: $<1410 = 2.49$; $1411-2560 = 2.70$; $2561-4350 = 2.66$; $4351+ = 2.56$.

Marital status means: married/cohabiting = 2.63; divorced/separated = 2.52;

widowed = 2.88 ($n=16$, interpret cautiously); single = 2.55.

Children: yes = 2.56; no = 2.63.

Hypothesis tests

Sex t-test: $t = -0.78$, $p = 0.437$. Not statistically significant.

Education Chi-square: chi-square = 10.84, $df = 6$, $p = 0.093$.

Age regression: $\beta = 0.00117$, $p = 0.717$, R-squared approximately 0.

Diagnostics and limitations

Residual normality is not fully satisfied because the five-point outcome is discrete.

No clear funnel pattern was observed, so homoscedasticity was considered acceptable.

Limitations: ordinal outcome treated as continuous, complete-case bias and cross-sectional design.

Conclusion

NHS satisfaction is only weakly structured by the socio-demographic characteristics examined.

Sex, education and age show no statistically significant relationship with satisfaction.